

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the paralegal role advertised through No1 Legal and Professional. My interest is practical: I have over a year of hands-on legal experience across litigation and client advisory work, and I am looking to continue that in a fee-earner-supporting role at a central London firm.

My most directly relevant experience is my year at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, where I supported fee earners across two dispute-resolution teams. In the International Arbitration team I reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and tracked outstanding actions and deadlines across a complex investment arbitration. In Real Estate Disputes I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials, handled court filings, and maintained matter records on iManage. Both rotations required me to manage large volumes of documents across competing deadlines, which is the practical core of supporting fee earners in a litigation practice.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire, where I have worked as a Legal Adviser since July 2026, I manage matters independently from first interview through to submission. I take detailed factual statements, draft correspondence, prepare application documents, and maintain confidential case records. The work covers housing, employment, family, debt and welfare benefits, so I regularly deal with the kind of procedural and client communication demands that arise in a general litigation or family law caseload. The need to explain complex rules clearly to people in difficult situations has also sharpened how I communicate with clients.

I am available for immediate interview and can start promptly. The role's breadth across conveyancing, litigation, private client and family law suits my background: my experience spans residential landlord and tenant disputes, international arbitration, and direct client advisory work, so I am comfortable moving between different types of matter. I would welcome the opportunity to bring that range to a busy central London practice.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva